GRADUATE RECOMMENDATION BRIEF

# The case for Akash

Narrative guide for Samina's recommendation across CS, machine learning, robotics, and engineering programs.

CORE THESIS

**Akash operated as an unusually independent early-career engineer who turned ambiguous enterprise problems into tested, documented, reusable AI systems.**

## SUGGESTED LETTER ARC

1. **Establish perspective**
   Explain how closely you managed Akash, the internship scope, and your basis for evaluating him.

2. **Anchor in Claims AI**
   Show how he crossed application, AWS, knowledge, authentication, voice, testing, and readiness boundaries.

3. **Add a second proof point**
   Use knowledge governance, Pega modernization, AEM delivery, or infrastructure to show adaptability.

4. **Describe how he worked**
   Emphasize independence, evidence-based judgment, privacy awareness, testing, and clear handoffs.

5. **Connect to graduate study**
   Tie open-ended problem solving, rapid learning, and systems depth to advanced CS, ML, or robotics work.

6. **Close directly**
   State the strength of your recommendation, whether you would hire him again, and any honest peer comparison.

## QUALITIES WORTH SUBSTANTIATING

- Unusual independence for an intern
- Rapid learning across unfamiliar systems
- Technical depth plus business awareness
- Honest treatment of evidence and limits
- Strong documentation and knowledge transfer
- Clear communication across stakeholders

## MOST VALUABLE COMPARISONS

If accurate, explain whether Akash performed beyond normal intern expectations, needed unusually little supervision, earned broader scope, or ranked among your strongest early-career engineers.

## TARGET PROGRAMS

Stanford · CMU ML · CMU Robotics · Princeton · Penn · Berkeley · Columbia

## WHAT MAKES THE LETTER PERSUASIVE

- Two detailed stories are stronger than a long technology inventory.
- Specific observations about independence, judgment, and growth are stronger than generic praise.
- The conclusion should explicitly state readiness for rigorous graduate work and the strength of the recommendation.
- Use only facts personally observed; omit confidential details and unverified adoption, savings, ROI, or impact claims.

MANAGER EVIDENCE PAGE

# What Akash did at New York Life

Software Engineering Intern, TDAV Team | May-August 2026 | A source-grounded set of memory prompts for Samina.

ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY

**Built applied-AI systems across claims, governed knowledge, legacy modernization, website engineering, cloud infrastructure, and business automation.**

## Claims AI - primary recommendation story

Worked across an AWS-based text and voice claims experience connecting application code, enterprise services, knowledge, forms, authentication, and business rules.

- Mapped the end-to-end experience across routes, document preview, data, APIs, cloud services, and production risks.
- Improved privacy-conscious observability, isolated data handling, approval controls, content rendering, and voice-related tools.
- Diagnosed browser, API, streaming, authentication, permission, and cloud-configuration issues.
- Built readiness checks, test/fix/retest loops, UAT coverage, browser verification, and detailed handoff documentation.

## Company Brain / NYL Knowledge

Helped turn fragmented operational material into governed knowledge usable by people and AI.

- Built ingestion and source-to-topic synthesis workflows.
- Added provenance, citations, freshness, review states, and usefulness gates.
- Separated raw evidence, durable knowledge, customer-safe guidance, and employee-only material.
- Created read-only connector tooling, dashboards, and executive summaries.

## Pega and legacy modernization

Made opaque low-code and legacy artifacts inspectable, traceable, and understandable to reviewers.

- Inspected exports, Java archives, XML, manifests, dependencies, and rule classes.
- Built resumable extraction and recovery workflows.
- Translated technical rules into business-readable logic.
- Supported impact, drift, test, approval, and audit workflows under read-only boundaries.

## AEM website engineering

Connected design and requirements to implementation and browser verification.

- Worked from Jira/Figma context through repository setup, components, local preview, and testing.
- Created reusable workflows and documentation while navigating enterprise environment constraints.
- Used clean worktrees, feature tracking, and browser evidence to protect delivery quality.

## Platform and business automation

Supported the infrastructure and reusable operating artifacts around the AI work.

- Contributed to infrastructure-as-code, email/streaming integration, configuration, and access diagnosis.
- Built reusable skills, connectors, scaffolds, setup notes, reports, dashboards, and review tools.
- Separated projected value from verified outcomes and left owner-ready handoffs.

## WHAT THESE EXAMPLES DEMONSTRATE

- Independent ownership, rapid learning, full-system thinking, and strong engineering judgment.
- Ability to translate between technical implementation, business rules, evidence, and stakeholder needs.
- A habit of verifying work, protecting data and permissions, documenting limitations, and enabling knowledge transfer.

*Verify before use: approximately 12,000 intended service representatives and approximately 13,000 source documents.*